

Comfort, Comfort Ye My People

- 1 Comfort, comfort ye my people,
speak ye peace, thus saith our God;
comfort those who sit in darkness,
mourning 'neath their sorrow's load.
Speak ye to Jerusalem
of the peace that waits for them;
tell her that her sins I cover,
and her warfare now is over.
- 2 Hark, the voice of one that crieth
in the desert far and near,
bidding all to true repentance,
since the kingdom now is here.
O that warning cry obey!
Now prepare for God away;
let the valleys rise to meet him,
and the hills bow down to greet him.
- 3 Make ye straight what long was crooked,
make the rougher places plain;
let your hearts be true and humble,
as befits his holy reign.
For the glory of the Lord
now o'er earth is shed abroad;
and all flesh shall see the token
that his word is never broken.

Words: Johannes Olearius, 1671; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1863; alt. (Isaiah 40:1-5)

Music: Genevan Psalter, 1551

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